Toulouse, France
http://www.sbc4d.com/

Where ICT meets social and economic development

SBC4D

Overview

SBC4D specializes in research & development, program management and execution in the ICT for Social and Economic development (ICTD) domain. Founded in 2009, SBC4D includes 6 senior consultants that have decades of experience in successful implementation of programs and projects in the domain. Our activities are structured around 4 pillars:

- **Mobile for Development**: Supporting organizations and governments to mainstream mobile technologies in social and economic development. This includes research studies on all related domains such as mobile money or mobile service innovation.
- **Open Data**: Supporting organizations and governments to embrace Open Data, enable them to release and reuse available data and create ecosystem for social and economic impact.
- **Impact Assessment**: Supporting organizations and governments to setup appropriate monitoring, evaluation, and impact assessment framework, measure relevant indicators and define strategies and policy recommendations to reach the required targets.
- **Accessibility and User Experience**: Supporting organizations and governments to achieve a Web of quality using global standards and best practices for Accessibility, Usability, Information Architecture, User Interfaces, Internationalization, Search Engine Optimization and a pleasant user experience in general.

Activities & Services

In each of our 4 pillars, SBC4D is able to deliver end-to-end services from the requirement phase till implementation and evaluation. Our objective is to deliver timely high-quality high-impact results to our customers.

1. **Mobile for Development (M4D)**
   SBC4D's CEO Stéphane Boyera is a pioneer in the domain of M4D since 2004. Our expertise and experience spans from strategy definition, project management, research studies, implementation and deployment, including business modelling. Specific to technology expertise we support our clients in all mobile technologies from SMS, to USSD to smartphone applications. Our core expertise is on voice and IVR technologies, on interfaces for people with low reading skills and low exposure to ICT and on multi-platform multi-screen distributed applications, with a special focus on mobile native (iOS, Android, etc.) and web clients. In the domain of voice, we specialize in user interface design, speech technologies (text-to-speech and speech recognition for local languages), and business modelling. Our extensive network of contacts and long-term relationships with all major mobile operators, particularly in developing countries, allow us to provide end-to-end solutions including large-scale deployments at country, regional and global level.

   In terms of sectors, we have a core expertise in health - agriculture - supporting small-holder farmers to access new markets and ICT-based extension services-, in media - citizen journalism platforms and community radio station support and extension - and in education and mobile learning, where we are well active in different networks such as UNESCO mobile learning Initiative and the USAID mEducation Alliance. We have cross-sector expertise on mobile-data collection in developing countries, and we have also a long time experience and expertise on mobile money platforms, including implementation and integration in mobile ICT services.

   Among our major projects, we managed the EU-funded VOICES project[1] involving 13 partners in Europe and Africa, focusing on agriculture in Mali and health in Senegal. We were also the technical manager in charge of the mobile implementation of the UN My World project[2].

2. **Open Data**
   SBC4D has specific expertise in Open Data and Linked Government Data. We are cooperating with Governments and other organisations in low and middle income countries to develop their open data initiative and release their data to the community, covering all aspects from organisational and legal to technologies, taking in consideration the social, economic, legal, administrative & technological aspects in each case. At SBC4D, we focus not only on

[1] http://www.mvoices.eu
[2] http://www.worldwewant2015.org

data release but also on creating ecosystems for the use and re-use of the released data by other actors such as civil society, academia, business, media or any other organisations that may benefit of them.

Our team members are pioneers in the field and experienced eGovernment and Web Standards practitioners, bringing extensive hands-on experience acquired by the implementation of more than twenty local, regional and national Open Data projects all around the world. This includes pioneering Open Government Data methodologies and studies[3], leading technical management of OGD initiatives in e.g. Ghana or Spain[4], or the complete redefinition of the European ePSIPlatform[5] action plan. We also participate in the Open Government Partnership initiative[6] and in the Global Open Data for Agriculture and Nutrition (GODAN)[7].

SBC4D can provide support on strategic analysis, feasibility studies, functional development, and implementation (e.g. engineering, standards, metadata and interoperability) throughout the OGD life cycle. We can also provide support on the development and implementation of action plans for the setup and evolution of the stakeholders' ecosystem essential to generate value from data released.

3. **Impact Assessment**

Our manager in charge of the Impact assessment department is a world-recognized expert in the domain. She has been in charge of designing and implementing the Mo Ibrahim's index on African Governance[8] till 2011 and the World Wide Web Foundation's Web Index[9] since then. Our expertise spans from designing the methodological and statistical framework for specific impact assessment activities, till implementing data collection in the field, analysing results and providing detailed recommendation to our customers on how to reach their target objectives.

4. **Accessibility and User Experience**

For the last ten years, we have been doing research, consultancy, education and outreach projects devoted to make a better use of the Web, both for governments and private companies. We advise throughout all the project life cycle (analysis, design, development, deployment, maintenance, etc.), working on capacity building, quality, best practices policies, conducting initial evaluations, advising on tools and platforms, consulting and assisting during development phase as well as monitoring and auditing the final results.

Geography

SBC4D is able to mobilize relevant resources in its international network to ensure the success of all the initiatives we are driving. In particular, our network covers the following countries: Mali, Burkina Faso, Senegal, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda, India, Indonesia, Burundi, Mexico, Uruguay, Chile, Nigeria, Ethiopia, Uganda, Liberia, Mozambique, Cameroon, South Africa, Ivory Coast, Colombia, Brazil, Madagascar, Niger, Ivory Coast, Togo, Benin, Botswana, Zimbabwe, Bangladesh, Tanzania, Egypt, Morocco, Tunisia, Cambodia, Zambia.

Customers

Our staff has provided services, directly or indirectly, to many organizations including:

To learn more about SBC4D, our publications and projects, please visit http://www.sbc4d.com/, scan the code to the right or contact Stéphane Boyera, Chief Executive Officer, at stephane@sbc4d.com.

[3] http://www.webfoundation.org/2011/05/open-government-data-reports-published/
[4] http://datos.gob.es/datos/
[5] http://epsiplatform.eu/
[6] http://www.opengovpartnership.org/
[7] http://godan.info/
[8] http://www.moibrahimfoundation.org/interact/
[9] http://thewebindex.org